Tatiana Hiller

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2026–27 Economics Job Market Candidate

Primary fields: Public Economics, Labor Economics
Secondary fields: Demography and Health
Citizenship: Colombian, German

Dissertation Committee and References

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Gies College of Business
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Education

University of California, Davis
Ph.D. in Economics — 2020–2027 (expected)

Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia
M.A. in Economics — 2017
B.A. in Economics — 2015

Job Market Paper

The Effect of Savings Annuitization on Elderly Outcomes

I estimate the causal effects of annuitization on old-age outcomes. Annuities insure retirees against outliving their savings by providing income for life, yet whether annuitizing pension wealth improves retirees' well-being remains an open empirical question. I exploit a rule in Colombia's private pension system under which retirees whose savings exceed an individual-specific threshold receive a life annuity and those below it receive a lump sum. Using administrative records covering the universe of retirees from 2008 to 2023, linked to death records and the social-assistance registry, I implement a regression discontinuity design at this threshold. Annuitization increases life expectancy within the 17-year observation window by 1.3 years and reduces social-assistance registration by 23 percentage points. Mortality effects emerge two to three years after retirement and are concentrated among lower-wage retirees, consistent with annuitization easing financial constraints later in retirement. These results provide some of the first causal evidence on the effects of annuitization and show that pension payout design has lasting consequences for longevity and reliance on the social safety net.

Working Papers

Public Externalities of Universal Health Care Access

with Leonardo Peñaloza-Pacheco and Sandra V. Rozo

> Does extending health coverage to an excluded population affect mortality among those already insured? In 2022 Colombia granted two million Venezuelan migrants full health coverage in place of emergency-only care. Comparing municipalities more and less exposed to the program before and after its onset, we find that one standard deviation of exposure reduced Colombian mortality by 1.8 percent, one native life a year per 300 migrants covered. After the program migrants made a more efficient use of the health services, providers were paid regularly rather than late for emergency episodes, and the deaths averted are those timely treatment prevents. The net fiscal cost is USD $58,000 per Colombian life saved.

Consequences of Growing Up Displaced: Evidence from Displaced Children in Colombia

with Andrés Moya and Sandra V. Rozo

World Bank Policy Research Working Paper No. 10765

> We examine how forced displacement shapes child development beyond socioeconomic disadvantage. Using original data on roughly 1,600 Venezuelan refugees, Colombian internally displaced, and non-displaced children in Medellín, Colombia, we adapt rank-rank regressions from the intergenerational mobility literature to a setting of forced displacement, ranking each child's developmental outcomes against household wealth. We document substantial gaps that persist after holding wealth and parental background fixed, and we show that the cause of displacement shapes their nature. Venezuelan refugees, displaced by acute material deprivation, fall 19 and 13 rank points behind in cognitive and physical development; Colombian children displaced by armed conflict instead fall 12 rank points behind in depression and exhibit elevated trauma. Access to regularization and social services is associated with narrower gaps.

Publications

South–South Migration and Female Labor Supply in the Dominican Republic

with Marisol Rodríguez Chatruc

Journal of Economic Geography, 23(2): 419–448 2023

¿Cómo nos reconciliamos? El papel que desempeña la violencia en las actitudes frente a la reconciliación

[How Do We Reconcile? The Role of Violence in Attitudes toward Reconciliation]

In S. Botero and M. García Sánchez (eds.), *Paz y Opinión Pública en Colombia*, Ediciones Uniandes 2024

Growth and Inclusion Trajectories of Colombian Functional Territories

with Leopoldo Fergusson and Ana María Ibáñez

Sobre México. Temas de Economía, 1: 79–125 2020

Delineating Functional Territories from Outer Space

with Julio A. Berdegué, Juan Mauricio Ramírez, Santiago Satizábal, Isidro Soloaga, Juan Soto, Miguel Uribe, and Olga Vargas

Latin American Economic Review, 28: 4 2019

Work in Progress

Aging and Local Economies: Evidence on Mobility, Labor Markets, Housing, and Regulation

with Giovanni Peri

Black Immigrants in the United States: Economic Convergence and the Role of Place

with Giovanni Peri and Reem Zaiour

Financial Incentives, Reference Points, and Retirement

Research and Professional Experience

University of California, Davis 2023–Present
Graduate Student Researcher for Giovanni Peri, Department of Economics
Graduate Student Coordinator, Global Migration Center

World Bank, Development Research Group, Washington, D.C. 2022
Short Term Consultant

Inter-American Development Bank, Migration Initiative, Washington, D.C. 2019–2020
Research Fellow / Consultant

Universidad de los Andes, Department of Economics, Bogotá 2015–2019
Research Assistant to Ana María Ibáñez, Leopoldo Fergusson, and Andrés Moya

Conference Presentations

2026	RIDGE–LACEA; The Economics of Longevity and Ageing (CEPR); 3rd IDB Research Conference; CEGA Research Retreat; LACEA–LAMES
2025	All-California Labor Economics Conference; 118th Annual Conference on Taxation (NTA); Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM); Empirical Studies of Conflict Research and Policy Conference (ESOC)

Fellowships and Awards

Miguel Velez Fellowship, UC Davis Graduate Studies (USD 40,600, tuition and stipend) 2026
NTA Fiscal Sustainability Fellowship, National Tax Association (USD 2,000) 2026
Graduate Research Award, UC Davis Department of Economics (USD 6,350) 2024–2025
Provost's First-Year Ph.D. Fellowship, UC Davis (USD 25,000 stipend) 2020
Teaching Assistant Award, Universidad de los Andes, Department of Economics 2017
Undergraduate Scholarship (two-year tuition), Fundación Roberto Michelsen 2013–2015

Teaching Experience

University of California, Davis, Teaching Assistant
Intermediate Macro Theory (ECN 101) Spring 2022, Spring 2023
Principles of Microeconomics (ECN 001) Winter 2023
Public Finance (ECN 131) Fall 2021, Fall 2022
Intermediate Micro Theory (ECN 100B) Winter 2022

Universidad de los Andes, Teaching Assistant
Impact Evaluation: Statistics and Economics (graduate) Summer 2018
Behavioral and Experimental Economics (undergraduate) 2016–2019
Intermediate Microeconomics (undergraduate) 2016–2019

Service and Skills

Referee	Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Labor Research; Inter-American Development Bank
Memberships	American Economic Association; Global Migration Center, UC Davis
Languages	Spanish (native); English (fluent, TOEFL 110/120); German (fluent, Sprachdiplom C1)
Software	Stata, R, Python, MATLAB, LaTeX